

Year 1 Phonics: Short Vowel a

Aussie Primary Academy | ACARA v9.0 Target: AC9E1LY09

Name: _____

Date: _____

Learning Intention: I can hear, read and write the short /a/ sound in simple words.

Mini Lesson: The short vowel a can sound like the /a/ in cat, bag and map. Say each word slowly and listen for the middle sound.

A. Say the word. Circle the picture if you hear the short /a/ sound.



cat



sun



bag



dog



map



hat

B. Blend and read. Draw a line under the short a sound.

c a t = cat

m a p = map

b a g = bag

h a t = hat

t a p = tap

j a m = jam

C. Write the missing vowel. Use a or o.

1. c _ t _____

2. d _ g _____

3. m _ p _____

4. h _ t _____

5. p _ t _____

6. b _ g _____

Short Vowel a Practice

Read, write and explain your thinking

Name: _____

Date: _____

D. Read each sentence. Tick the sentence that uses a short a word.

- ☐ The cat sat on the mat.
- ☐ The dog sits by the log.
- ☐ I can pack my bag.
- ☐ The map is on the desk.

E. Sort the words. Write each word in the best box.

Words: cat, dog, map, sun, bag, hat

Short a words

Not short a words

F. Draw and label one short a word.

My word: _____

Sentence: I see a _____.

I Can Checklist: ☐ I can hear short a. ☐ I can read short a words. ☐ I can write a word with short a.

Answer Key and Teaching Notes

For teachers, parents and tutors

Answer Key

A: Circle cat, bag, map, hat. B: Underline a in cat, map, bag, hat, tap, jam. C: 1 a, 2 o, 3 a, 4 a, 5 o, 6 a.

D: Tick sentences 1, 3 and 4. Sentence 2 has no short a focus word. E: Short a words: cat, map, bag, hat. Not short a words: dog, sun. F: Answers will vary: cat, bag, map, hat, jam, tap, mat.

Parent / Teacher Tip: Ask the child to stretch each word slowly: c-a-t, m-a-p, b-a-g. Encourage them to touch each sound with one finger, then blend the word together.
Curriculum Gap Filled: Builds early phonics confidence by connecting pictures, sounds, letters, blending and simple sentence reading.

Teacher Feedback

Strengths: _____

Next Steps: _____

Teacher Signature: _____ Date: _____